

Marie Aurélie Lapierre

Post-doc researcher

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Research interests

Urban economics, Labor economics, Peer effects and Neighborhood effects, Housing market, Microeconometrics

Current and previous positions

Sept. 2025 – **Post-doctoral researcher**, *Université Paris Dauphine-PSL*, France

Present Junior Professor Chair: Laura Khoury

Sept. 2023 – **Temporary Lecturer (demi-ATER)**, *CY Cergy Paris Université and THEMA*,
Aug. 2025 France

Oct. 2020 – **Full-time PhD student (contrat doctoral)**, *Université Lumière Lyon 2 and GATE-*
Aug. 2023 *LSE*, France

Education

2020 – 2025 **PhD in Economics**, *Université Lumière Lyon 2 and GATE-LSE*, France

Title Urban spatial inequalities and Labor market outcomes

Supervisor Florence Goffette-Nagot

Jury Pierre-Philippe Combes, Camille Hémet, Benoît Schmutz-Bloch, Elisabet Viladecans-Marsal

Defense date June 26th, 2025

2017–2020 **Master degree in Economic Analysis and Policy**, *Economics and Finance Msc program*, with highest distinction, *GATE-LSE and Université Lumière Lyon 2*, France

2018–2019 **Year dedicated to volunteering work** in Mauritius (literacy courses teacher at *Caritas*) and in India (Sponsorship Coordinator at *Kalkeri Sangeet Vidyalaya* NGO)

2014–2017 **Bachelor degree in Economics and Business Administration**, with honours, *Université Lumière Lyon 2*, France

Bachelor degree in Political Science, *major in the humanitarian sector*, with honours, *Université Lumière Lyon 2*, France

2013–2014 **French Economic and Social Baccalaureate**, with highest distinction, *Lycée des Mascareignes*, Mauritius

Research stay

Sept. 2022 – **Institut d'Economia de Barcelona (IEB)**, *Universitat de Barcelona*, Barcelona,
Dec. 2022 Spain, invited by Prof. Elisabet Viladecans-Marsal

Working papers

Title Neighborhood effects and Job search behaviors

Co-author Florence Goffette-Nagot (CNRS, Cergic ENS Lyon)

Abstract Do neighbors influence job search behavior? We address this question using a Manski-type model with four search channels. Results show that neighbors' use of a channel affects individuals' own use, particularly for signaling one's job search in the media and using personal or professional networks, as opposed to more conventional methods such as contacting employers or intermediaries. We also find effects of neighbors' occupations. Our findings suggest that local social interactions may amplify labor market inequalities across neighborhoods, as there are stronger incentives to search when unemployed neighbors are actively searching and employed neighbors hold higher-status jobs.

This paper has received the ACDD 2022 Best Paper Award. Actual state: submitted.

Work in progress

Title Big-box Stores, Local Employment and City Shape

Co-authors Francesco Alosa (ISEG, Lisbon) & Laura Khoury (Université Paris Dauphine-PSL)

This project is part of the wider public discussion regarding the impact of large retail outlets on medium-sized French cities. The opening of supermarkets and hypermarkets raises questions about their effects, both as drivers of local consumption and as potential disruptors of the economic and spatial structures of territories, notably due to the competitive pressure they exert on small businesses. While the consequences for local employment are relatively well documented, existing literature does not enable these effects to be identified at a fine geographical scale, nor does it consider several complementary dimensions. This work aims to address these shortcomings by empirically analysing the impact of large store openings on: (i) the survival of small retailers and a broad set of local employment outcomes (employment levels, job quality) at various geographical scales; and (ii) complementary dimensions such as real estate prices, electoral behavior, well-being or crime. The project draws on several administrative and economic datasets, uses event-study and difference-in-differences methods, and exploits the municipal-level political authorisation system governing store openings in France.

Title Wage compensation for housing costs: are skilled and unskilled workers equal?

Abstract The affordable housing issue is now at the center of public concerns. It reflects the growing difficulties households face in accessing housing in large cities. The interurban framework developed by Rosen (1979) and Roback (1982) posits that as housing costs increase with city size, wages should adjust accordingly to compensate for these higher costs and restore equilibrium. However, this relationship is far from automatic and may differ depending on workers' skill levels. The objective of this work is to provide a robust measure of the relative compensation for housing costs between high-skilled and low-skilled workers in French cities, as well as its evolution over the 2012–2020 period. To do so, I propose an original method to construct a composite housing cost index that integrates all three segments of the French housing market: housing prices, private rents, and social housing. I also construct, based on the urban wage premia literature, local wage indexes by skill level. The results reveal two distinct periods: (i) a first 2012–2015 period in which both skill levels receive relatively similar levels of wage compensation; (ii) a second, from 2016 onward, in which housing costs rise and high-skilled are more compensated. Importantly, the findings show that public housing mitigates part of this divergence: excluding social housing from the index amplifies the estimated gap in compensation. This paper thus contributes to the understanding of affordable housing issues in France by highlighting a crucial yet often overlooked dimension: the unequal wage compensation for housing costs across skill levels.

Title The impact of housing costs on labor market trajectories

Co-author Ghizlen Ouasbaa Azzouani (IEB & EUNCET)

Abstract This article examines the extent to which housing costs shape workers' labor market trajectories. We provide empirical evidence showing that housing prices contribute to widening labor market disparities between high-skilled and low-skilled workers in French cities. We focus on two key outcomes: the probability of obtaining a permanent contract and the probability of being promoted. Our analysis uses an interurban framework and draws on rich French administrative data that track workers' careers between 2010 and 2018, combined with detailed data on housing prices. To account for the non-random spatial sorting of individuals across cities, we implement a two-step approach à la Combes et al. (2008). This strategy is complemented by instrumental variable techniques that address endogeneity between housing and labor markets. Our results show that high housing prices exacerbate inequalities in access to permanent contracts between skill levels, an effect that is particularly pronounced among workers aged 35 and over and largely driven by low-skilled women. We do not find any significant effect on job promotions.

Conferences and Seminars

- 2025 ADRES 2025 Job Market Conference (Strasbourg), THEMA PhD seminar (Cergy), GATE PhD seminar (Lyon)
- 2024 UEA European Meeting (Copenhagen), AFSE Annual Congress (Bordeaux), THEMA Theoretical and Applied Economics Seminar (Cergy), CERGIC internal seminar (Lyon), GATE DiVER seminar (Lyon), GATE DiVER seminar (Lyon)
- 2023 LEMNA PhD seminar (Nantes), GAINS seminar (Le Mans), PSE Workshop "Neighborhoods and local interactions" (Paris), ECINEQ (Aix-en-Provence), THEMA Theoretical and Applied Economics Seminar (Cergy)
- 2022 IWIP Session IEB (Barcelona), LAGV (Marseille), ACDD (Strasbourg), TEPP Winter School (Poster sessions, Aussois), EDSEG 486 Annual Workshop (Lyon)
- 2021 UEA North American Meeting (online), GATE DiVER seminar (Lyon), GATE PhD seminar (Lyon)

Participation in the Public Debate

- 2022-2026 Research Program: "Affordable Housing and Land: Economic Challenges",** *Union Sociale pour l'Habitat*, Participation
 - Project "Housing markets: land use dynamics, wealth dynamics, price dynamics", led by a team of economists and sociologists (GATE, ERUDITE, Centre Max Weber, LESSEM)
 - Nov. 2023 Presentation at the annual inter-team seminar, Ministry of Ecological Transition and Territorial Cohesion, Paris
 - Oct. 2024 Presentation at the researcher-practitioner seminar, Ministry of Ecological Transition and Territorial Cohesion, Paris
 - June 2025 Participation in the internal seminar, Caisse des Dépôts, Paris
 - 2026 Contribution to the drafting of a public policy report

Awards, Scholarship and Grants

- May 2022 **Best paper award**, *Augustin Cournot Doctoral Days (ACDD) 2022*
- 2022-2025 **"Marchés du logement : dynamique d'usage du sol, dynamique des richesses, dynamique des prix"**, *Union Sociale pour l'Habitat*, participation
- 2020–2023 **Full Research Grant**, *French Ministry of Higher Education*, Université Lumière Lyon 2
- 2014–2020 **Excellence-Major scholarship**, *French Ministry of Foreign Affairs*, Agency for French Education Abroad (AEFE)

Teaching Experience

- 2023–2025 **Principles of Macroeconomics**, *CY Cergy Paris Université*, Teaching assistant, 1st year undergraduate (L1), 6 groups (90 hours)
- Coordinators: Thomas Brodaty and Agustín Pérez-Barahona
 - Introductory course to macroeconomics: key aggregates, GDP components, monetary mechanisms, economic fluctuations (demand and supply shocks). Preparation and correction of exams.
- 2024–2025 **Principles of Microeconomics**, *CY Cergy Paris Université*, Teaching assistant, 1st year undergraduate (L1), 3 groups (45 hours)
- Coordinators: Cécile Boyer and Pauline Morault
 - Introductory course to microeconomics: the tools of the microeconomist, introduction to game theory, consumer theory, producer theory and market equilibrium. Preparation and correction of exams.
- 2023–2024 **Microeconomics II**, *CY Cergy Paris Université*, Teaching assistant, 1st year undergraduate (L1), 3 groups (45 hours)
- Coordinators: Laurence Jacquet and Pauline Morault
 - Introductory course to microeconomics: consumer theory (budget constraint, preferences, optimal choice) and producer theory (production factors and costs, profit maximisation). Preparation and correction of exams.
- 2022–2023 **Microeconomics**, *Université Lumière Lyon 2*, Teaching assistant, 1st year undergraduate (L1), 2 groups (26 hours)
- Coordinator: Walid Hichri
 - Basic concepts and instruments of microeconomics: consumer theory, producer theory, the market. Preparation and correction of exams.
- 2021–2022 **Dynamic Macroeconomics**, *Université Lumière Lyon 2*, Teaching assistant, 3rd year undergraduate (L3), 2 groups (35 hours)
- Coordinator: Rym Aloui
 - Long-run macroeconomics. Topics covered: the sources economic growth, inequalities and health. Introduction to macroeconomic modeling through the Solow, Malthus and Lucas models.
 - Preparation and correction of exams. Helping and advising students for their pursuit in a Master degree.

Administrative positions

May 2022 – August 2023 PhD student representative (substitute), GATE-LSE council

PhD Training

- 2024 **Learning Group on GIS using Python (LeGoGISP)**, THEMA, CY Cergy Paris Université (Jan-May 2024)
- 2023 **GIS on R with Yves Croissant** (Université de La Réunion) (april)
- 2024 **Learning Group on hedonic regression models**, GATE-Lyon-St-Etienne (Feb-March 2024)
- 2022 **Urban economics**, UEA summer school, Institut d'Economia de Barcelona - Universitat de Barcelona (June 2022)
- 2022 **Public policy evaluation**, Theory and Evaluation of Public Policies (TEPP) Winter school, TEPP CNRS Research Federation (March 2022)
- 2021 **Analyzing Panel Data**, GSERM Global School in Empirical Research Methods, University of St-Gallen with Christopher Zorn (June 2021)
- 2021 **Introduction to Python**, Université de Lyon PhD training program with Julien Velcin (March 2021)

Skills

Software R (proficient), Python (intermediate), SAS (intermediate), $\text{\LaTeX}$, Zotero, MS Office
Language French (native), English (fluent), Mauritian Creole (fluent), Spanish (intermediate)

References

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